

Absolutely — **function** is a strong polysemy target because your passage uses it indirectly here:

> “Home should not only be **functional**...”

Here **functional** means **designed to work well for a practical purpose**, not merely decorative. The word family **function / functional** also covers **purpose, operation, social events, mathematical functions, software/programming, biological roles, and functioning properly**.

Word family: **function / functional / functionally / functionality / malfunction**

Base word: function

Verb forms: function, functions, functioned, functioning

Adjective: functional

Adverb: functionally

Noun: functionality

Related form: malfunction

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / adjective-family forms (相關形容詞)

Meaning in your passage: **functional = practical and useful** — 實用的；具實際功能的

Your sentence:

> “Home should not only be **functional**; it should also feel restful.”

Here **functional** means:

> **designed or arranged so that it works effectively for practical everyday needs.**

繁體中文：

能有效滿足實際用途和日常需要的；實用的、具功能性的

Natural translation:

> “Home should not only be functional...”

「家不應該只講求**實用功能**.....」

So here:

> **functional = 實用、能有效發揮用途**

1. **function = purpose / role** — 功能；用途；作用

The core noun meaning.

Practice 1

> “The main **function** of this room is relaxation.”

「這個房間的主要**功能 / 用途**是讓人放鬆。」

Practice 2

> “The frame has both a decorative and protective function.”

「這個畫框同時具有裝飾和保護**作用**。」

function = 某人 / 某物被設計或存在來完成的用途、作用或角色

2. **function** = specific job performed by a system/part — 功能；職能

A related but useful system sense.

Practice 3

> “Each button has a different **function**.”

「每個按鈕都有不同的**功能**。」

Practice 4

> “One function of the software is image editing.”

「這套軟件其中一項**功能**是編輯圖像。」

function = 系統、設備或部件可執行的一項特定工作

3. **function** = operation / working state — 運作；功能運作

Practice 5

> “The machine returned to normal **function**.”

「機器恢復正常**運作**。」

Practice 6

> “The injury affected the normal function of the hand.”

「受傷影響了手部的正常**功能**。」

****function = 某器官、系統或設備正常運作的狀態 / 能力****

4. ****function = social or official event — 活動；正式場合****

A major distinct noun meaning.

Practice 7

> “The museum held a private ****function**** for donors.”

「博物館為捐助者舉辦了一場私人****活動****。」

Practice 8

> “She attended an official function at the gallery.”

「她出席了畫廊的一個正式****場合 / 活動****。」

****function = 有組織的社交、正式或公共活動****

Register:

* formal

* especially BrE/common institutional English

5. ****function = mathematical relation — 函數****

A major academic meaning.

Practice 9

> “This graph represents a mathematical ****function****.”

「這幅圖表示一個數學****函數****。」

Practice 10

> “The value of the function changes with x.”

「這個**函數**的值會隨 x 改變。」

****function — mathematics = 把一個輸入值按照規則對應到一個輸出值的關係****

6. ****function = programming/software routine — 函式；函數****

A major computing meaning.

Practice 11

> “The program calls a ****function**** to process the image.”

「程式會呼叫一個**函式**來處理圖像。」

Practice 12

> “This function returns the total cost.”

「這個**函式**會回傳總成本。」

****function — programming = 執行特定任務、可被呼叫使用的一段程式碼****

Traditional Chinese terminology:

* 函式 — common in Taiwan/programming

* 函數 — also used in some contexts

7. ****function = biological role — 生理功能；作用****

A major science/medical sense.

Practice 13

> “The lungs perform an essential ****function****.”

「肺部執行一項重要的**生理功能**。」

Practice 14

> “Sleep supports normal brain function.”

「睡眠有助維持正常的腦部**功能**。」

****function — biology = 身體器官、細胞或生物系統所執行的特定作用****

8. ****function = verb, work/operate — 運作；發揮作用****

A major verb meaning.

Practice 15

> “The device is still ****functioning**** properly.”

「這個裝置仍然正常****運作****。」

Practice 16

> “The system cannot function without electricity.”

「這個系統沒有電就無法****運作****。」

****function — verb = 正常工作、運轉或執行其預定用途****

9. ****function as + role = 充當；發揮……作用****

A very common verb pattern.

Practice 17

> “The room also ****functions as**** a study.”

「這個房間也****兼作書房****。」

Practice 18

> “The painting functions as a focal point in the room.”

「這幅畫在房間中****起到視覺焦點的作用****。」

****function as + noun = 充當某角色 / 發揮某用途****

10. **functional = working properly — 功能正常的；可正常運作的**

A major adjective sense.

Practice 19

> “The old camera is still **functional**.”

「那部舊相機仍然**可以正常使用**。」

Practice 20

> “The system is fully functional again.”

「系統已恢復**完全正常運作**。」

functional = 能正常執行原本功能的

11. **functional = practical rather than decorative — 實用的；重功能的**

This is your exact source sense.

Practice 21 — Source

> “Home should not only be **functional**.”

「家不應該只講求**實用功能**。」

Practice 22

> “The furniture is simple but highly functional.”

「這些家具雖然簡單，但非常**實用**。」

functional = 設計重點在實際用途、便利和效率，而不只是外觀

12. **functional = having a specific purpose within a system — 功能性的；具有特定作用的**

A technical/scientific sense.

Practice 23

> “The design separates decorative and **functional** elements.”

「這個設計把裝飾元素和**功能性元素**分開。」

Practice 24

> “The protein has several functional regions.”

「這種蛋白質有幾個不同的**功能區域**。」

functional = 在整個系統中負責某項特定功能的

13. **functional** = able to manage everyday activities — 能維持日常生活功能的

A common health/psychology/general-use extension.

Practice 25

> “He remained **functional** despite being very tired.”

「即使非常疲累，他仍能**維持正常日常活動**。」

Practice 26

> “The goal is to help patients stay functional.”

「目標是幫助病人維持**日常生活功能**。」

functional = 能完成日常生活、工作或基本任務的

This is broader than simply “working mechanically”.

14. **functionality** = range/quality of functions — 功能性；功能

A major technology/product noun.

Practice 27

> “The app has useful **functionality**.”

「這個應用程式具有實用的**功能**。」

Practice 28

> “The update improves the software’s functionality.”

「這次更新改善了軟件的**功能性 / 實用功能**。」

****functionality = 系統 / 產品所具備的功能，以及這些功能能否有效使用****

15. ****functionality = practical usability — 實用性****

A design/product sense.

Practice 29

> “The designer balanced beauty and ****functionality****.”

「設計師在美感與****實用性****之間取得平衡。」

Practice 30

> “The room has good functionality despite its small size.”

「雖然房間很小，但****實用性****很高。」

****functionality = 某物在實際使用上的有效程度****

16. ****functionally = in practical/operational terms — 從功能上；實際上****

Practice 31

> “The two systems are ****functionally**** similar.”

「這兩個系統從****功能上****來說很相似。」

Practice 32

> “The room is functionally divided into two areas.”

「這個房間從****用途上****分成兩個區域。」

****functionally = 從實際功能 / 用途角度而言****

17. ****malfunction = fail to work properly — 故障；失靈****

A useful family extension.

Practice 33

> “The display ****malfunctioned**** during the presentation.”

「顯示器在簡報期間****故障****了。」

Practice 34

> “A sensor malfunction caused the problem.”

「感應器****故障****導致了問題。」

****malfunction = 機器、系統或器官未能正常運作****

Can be:

* noun: a malfunction

* verb: to malfunction

Important distinction: ****function vs purpose****

****purpose****

= why something exists/is done; intended aim.

****function****

= what it actually does / role it performs.

> purpose of a museum

> = 博物館存在的目的

> function of a door

> = 門所執行的功能

They overlap, but **function** is more operational.

Important distinction: **function** vs **use**

use

= what something is used for.

function

= built-in role or operation.

> “The use of this room is changing.”

= 這個房間的用途正在改變。

> “The main function of the device is cooling.”

= 裝置主要功能是冷卻。

Important distinction: **function** vs **role**

role

often refers to a person, institution, or abstract part played in a situation.

function

emphasizes task/purpose performed.

> role of a curator

> = 策展人的角色

> function of the lighting system

> = 照明系統的功能

Important distinction: **function** vs **feature**

You have **feature** mapped already.

feature

= an individual characteristic/capability.

function

= what the thing does.

> facial feature

> = 面部特徵

> software feature

> = 軟件功能特色

> function of the software

> = 軟件執行的作用

There is overlap in technology, but **feature** emphasizes an offered capability; **function** emphasizes operation/purpose.

Important distinction: **function** vs **functionality**

function

= one specific operation/purpose.

> “This function edits images.”

functionality

= overall functional capability/usability.

> “The software has strong functionality.”

So:

> function = 一項功能

> functionality = 整體功能性 / 功能範圍

Important distinction: **functional** vs **practical**

functional

= designed to work effectively for intended use.

practical

= sensible/useful in real-life conditions.

A chair can be functional because it works as a chair; a practical choice may consider cost, size, maintenance, etc.

In your source:

> functional home

> = 實用、好用的家居空間

Important distinction: **functional vs decorative**

functional

= serves a practical purpose.

decorative

= mainly intended to improve appearance.

> functional lighting

> = 實用照明

> decorative lighting

> = 裝飾照明

Something can be both.

Important distinction: **functional vs functioning**

functional

adjective:

= capable of working / practical.

functioning

participle adjective:
= currently operating.

> functional computer
> = 可正常使用的電腦

> functioning computer
> = 正在正常運作的電腦

Close, but emphasis differs.

Important distinction: **function as vs be**

be

states identity.

> “This room is a study.”

function as

states practical role.

> “This room functions as a study.”

= 這個房間實際上兼作書房。

It may not officially be designed as one.

Important distinction: **function — social event vs function — purpose**

Same noun, completely different sense.

Purpose:

> “The function of the frame is protection.”

= 畫框的作用是保護。

Event:

> “We attended a museum function.”

= 我們出席了博物館活動。

Excellent MCQ contrast.

Important distinction: **function — mathematics vs programming**

Mathematics:

> input → output relationship

= 函數

Programming:

> reusable block of code

= 函式 / 函數

The terms are related conceptually but technically distinct.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

- * **function — purpose/role** = 功能 / 用途 / 作用
- * **function — system capability** = 功能
- * **function — normal operation** = 運作 / 功能
- * **function — social event** = 正式活動 / 場合
- * **function — mathematics** = 函數
- * **function — programming** = 函式 / 函數
- * **function — biology** = 生理功能
- * **function — verb: operate** = 運作
- * **function as** = 充當 / 發揮.....作用
- * **functional — operational** = 可正常運作的
- * **functional — practical** = 實用的
- * **functional — technical role** = 功能性的
- * **functional — daily ability** = 能維持日常功能的
- * **functionality — technology** = 功能 / 功能性
- * **functionality — usability** = 實用性
- * **functionally** = 從功能 / 用途上
- * **malfunction** = 故障 / 失靈

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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function — purpose	某人 / 某物被設計或存在來完成的用途、作用或角色
function — system feature	系統、設備或部件可執行的一項特定工作
function — operation	器官、系統或設備正常工作的能力 / 狀態
function — event	有組織的正式、社交或公共活動
function — mathematics	把輸入值按照規則對應到輸出值的數學關係
function — programming	執行特定任務、可被呼叫的一段程式碼
function — biology	器官、細胞或生物系統執行的特定作用
function — verb	正常工作、運轉或執行預定用途
function as	充當某角色 / 發揮某用途
functional — operational	能正常執行原本功能的
functional — practical	能有效滿足實際用途與日常需要的
functional — technical	在系統中負責某項特定作用的
functionality	系統 / 產品具備的功能及其實際可用程度
malfunction	機器、系統或器官未能正常運作；故障

For your original sentence

> “Home should not only be **functional**; it should also feel restful.”

The exact meaning is:

functional = 家居空間不應只做到「好用、方便、能滿足日常需要」，還應該讓人感到放鬆舒適。

Natural translation:

> **「家不應該只講求實用功能，也應該讓人感到放鬆。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **function of a room** → 房間的用途 / 功能
- > **machine functions properly** → 機器正常運作
- > **formal function** → 正式活動
- > **mathematical function** → 數學函數
- > **programming function** → 程式函式
- > **functional furniture** → 實用家具
- > **fully functional** → 功能完全正常
- > **functionality** → 功能性 / 實用性
- > **malfunction** → 故障